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62530 PUTRAJAYA**

KERTAS PENERANGAN (*INFORMATION SHEET*)

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TAHAP / LEVEL	4 (FOUR)	
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TAJUK/TITLE : ADHERE TO CONTINUOUS EFFECTIVE LEARNING

TUJUAN/PURPOSE :

This Information Sheet is tended to describe the requirements in adhering to continuous effective learning. The person who is competent in this CA shall be able to effectively utilize management relationship capabilities.

PENERANGAN/INFORMATION :**1. TRAINING NEEDS ANALYSIS**

1.1 Conducting a training needs analysis / assessment is an essential first step in the planning of an effective training programme. A training needs analysis usually focuses on current and desired skills, knowledge and attitudes of the trainees (*Figure 1.1*). However, before specifying the training needs on an individual and organization level it may be necessary to carry out broader initial information gathering on the capacities of the organization and its environment. Analyzing the current capacities, strengths, and weaknesses of each, the needs analysis is able to provide a solid base of information which can direct the focus of the training needs analysis. It is common to focus only on the weaknesses and gaps in capacity. However, by also identifying strengths and opportunities of the organization, its employees, and environment, a more informed decision can be made on how training can strengthen capacity or if other approaches would be more effective.



Figure 1.1: Training Need Analysis.

1.2 There are many approaches to assessing the capacity of an organization within its context. These approaches may include specific analysiss, such as the Needs Analysis, Gap Analysis and Broad Capacity Analysis which have been outlined. Regardless of which approach is chosen, it is crucial that it is applied with flexibility towards the economical, cultural, political and social context. There

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is no single method for capacity analysis that can be followed strictly step by step, without adaptation to the specific situation.

1.3 Training is often seen as the solution to all capacity problems even though there are many situations training alone cannot be improved. Hence, the first priority of a needs analysis should be conducting some initial information gathering which is used to determine whether training is an appropriate approach; preventing investments into trainings that will not help the organization. When training is decided upon as the best way to develop capacity, the specification of training needs is essential for identifying who should be trained, what the focus of the training should be, and how to deliver the training. The trainer then uses this information to develop a training programme that is relevant both to the individual participants and their organizations. An understanding of the individual and organizational constraints and capabilities enables the trainer to devise practical steps to get the trainee from their current state to the desired post-training state. By identifying these constraints, capabilities, and potential enhancers and barriers to the transfer of learning in the beginning, a training design and delivery method to maximize the effect of the training can be developed.

2. TRAINING NEEDS ANALYSIS PROCESS

2.1 All training activities should be initiated by a demand, which for example can be problems or potential opportunities identified by an organization or individuals within an organization. Demand can also be triggered by issues expressed by politicians or beneficiaries of the organization's services. Training needs analysis has to be a flexible process but a general guidance is to start with a broad analysis that gradually becomes more specific.

2.2 *Figure 2.1* shows the different steps of analysis described in the following sections. Some of the steps can be carried out in parallel; however, it is crucial to determine if, and to what extent, training can contribute to achieving the desired capacity (*step 6*) before specifying the training needs (*step 7*). Throughout the analysis process data has to be collected and analyzed.

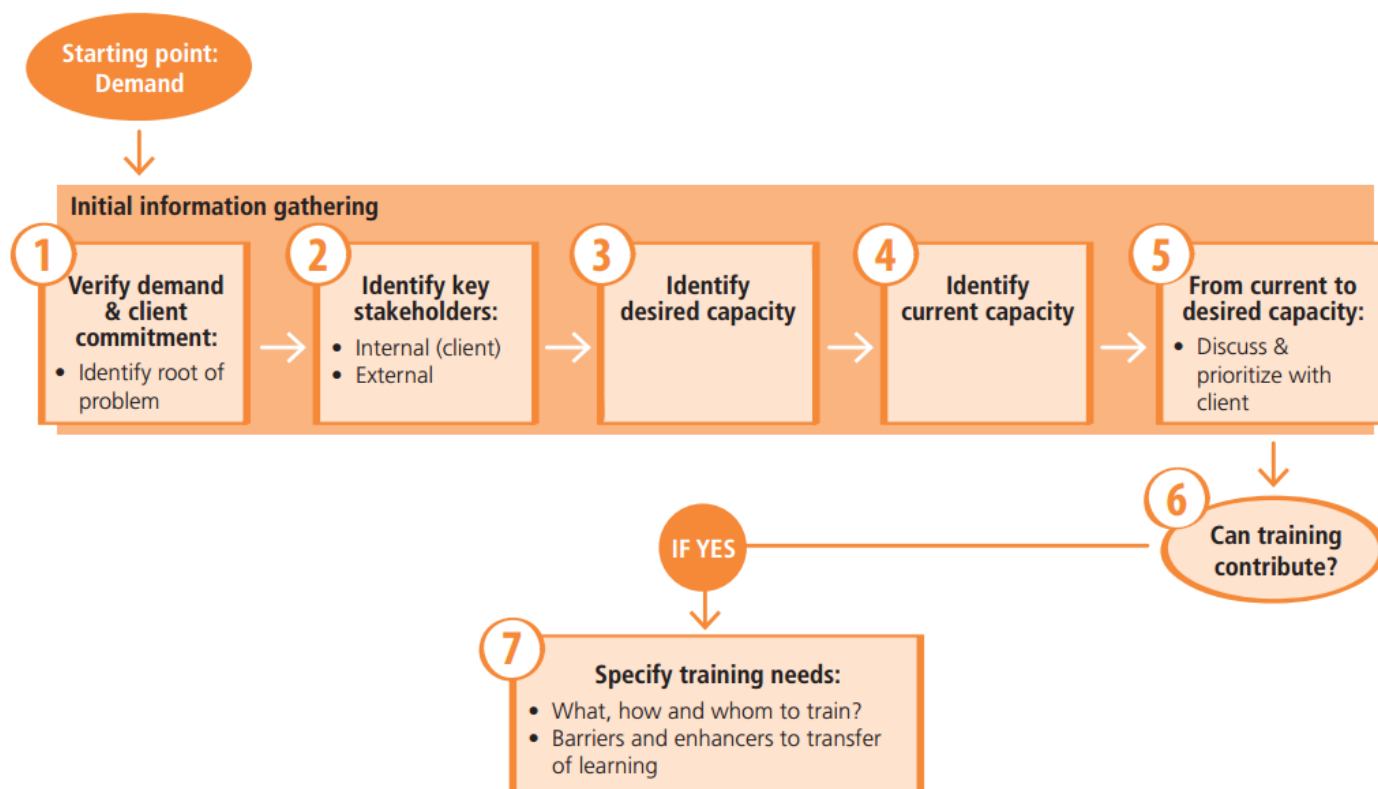


Figure 2.1 : The training needs analysis process.

3. COLLECTING AND ANALYSING

3.1 Information has to be collected and analyzed throughout the analysis/assessment. First, the initial information gathering focuses on identifying current and desired capacity usually in a broader organizational perspective. Later, the specific training needs are analysed. There are a range of methods available for data collection and analysis. What methods to choose depends on the stage of the analysis, what type of data is to be collected, and the available resources both within the organization studied and the institute conducting the analysis. Most likely a mixture of methods and sources of information will be required.

3.2 When collecting data, there are many possible sources such as internal documentation (for example previous analysis or annual reports), media, partners, beneficiaries and employees (Figure 3.2). To maximize the accuracy of the analysis, it is recommended to use several of these options as they all provide different perspectives on the work of the organization. Internally, it is important to

look at different levels of the organization, as managers and their staff may not agree on what the needs are. In addition, units and individuals that are high performing, as well as those with performance problems should be studied. It is common to only focus on the parts of the organization where capacity is lacking, but individuals and units with high capacity can provide useful information on what specific capacity is contributing to their performance.

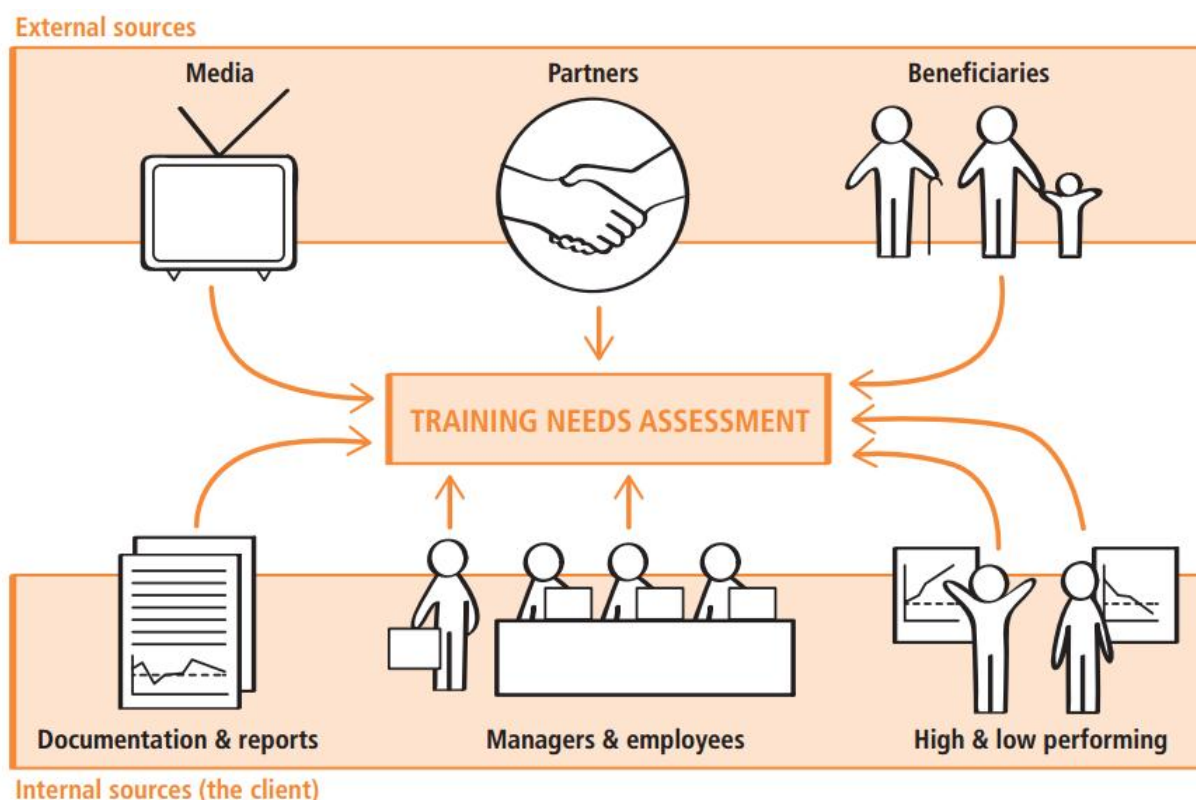


Figure 3.2: Possible sources for data collection.

3.3 Assessing the needs of an organization inevitably means consulting people for information, which is a skill in itself. The main methods for studying people's opinions, skills, attitudes and behaviours are interviews, observations, questionnaires (the main approaches are shown in Figure 3.3), surveys, and customer comment cards.

- i) **Interviews** can be carried out individually or in groups and be structured with pre-determined questions, or unstructured to discuss a topic more freely. Interviewing different people within an organization is a relatively quick way of getting an overview of for example a problem situation or the current capacity of the organization.

- ii) **Group interviews** gather a number of people to discuss a pre-determined topic. If carried out successfully, the method results in answers built on many people's opinions, which is suitable for attaining an overview of the issues and the context.
- iii) **Observations** are useful for understanding the work of the organization, such as through the study of behaviours; particularly regarding technical skills. It is often difficult to describe how a task is performed and observations can help in identifying people's actual behaviours. However, observations only give information on what is done, but it does not explain why it is done that way. To better understand the situation it is therefore recommended to combine observations with other data collection methods.
- iv) **Questionnaires** are a time efficient way of obtaining quantitative data and the method is particularly useful when the respondents are geographically wide spread. Questionnaires are often carried out to validate information from interviews or observations and to collect quantitative data on attitudes or knowledge of trainees, for example to determine how many employees have knowledge on a specific topic.
- v) **Surveys** are used to focus on specific areas of performance deficiency. Surveys can be administered either by management or an outside professional. The surveys consist of a written questionnaire that employees answer on an anonymous basis which will allow them to answer freely and be truthful with their answers. The questions on the survey should be highly oriented toward the specific tasks, responsibilities and needs of the organization and its employees.

DATA COLLECTION METHOD	MAIN TYPE OF DATA	STRENGTHS	CHALLENGES
Interviews	Qualitative/ Quantitative	• Allows for deep understanding • Flexible	• Interviewer might bias answers
Group Interviews/ Focus Groups	Qualitative	• Participants trigger each other	• Result depends on group dynamics (dominant personalities) • Interviewer might bias answers • time consuming to analyze
Questionnaires	Quantitative	• Easy to distribute • Anonymous responses possible • Online tools available for automatic compilation of data • Open and closed question structures possible	• Usually low response frequency • Questions might be misinterpreted • Open questions are time consuming to analyze
Observations	Qualitative/ Quantitative	• Good for studying actual behaviours of people • Provides information in its context (useful when the context is unfamiliar to the assessors)	• People might change behaviour when being observed • Time consuming to analyze

Figure 3.3: Strengths and challenges of different data collection methods.

- vi) **Customer comment cards** serve as a major source of information as to what the deficiencies may be. They often indicate what specific areas need improvement and why. Be sure that each question on the customer comment card is directed toward a specific service already offered in order to determine its effectiveness.

3.4 To transfer the collected data into valuable information the data has to be analyzed. Some data collection methods, such as video-recorded observations, require more time to analyze than to conduct, which has to be taken into account when planning the analysis and budgeting.

3.5 **KJ Analysis** is a method for analyzing qualitative data from many different sources and identifying the key points without losing the holistic perspective. Important pieces of information from interviews, questionnaires, observations or previous analyses are written on for example post-it notes and sorted according to how they relate to each other.

3.6 To facilitate the analysis of quantitative data the results can be compiled in a table format. Most online survey tools automatically do this. It is helpful to visualize the data in graphs or diagrams, both to better understand the information

and to be able to present clear and convincing results to the client and other involved stakeholders, such as funders.

4. BRIDGING THE ANALYSIS AND EVALUATION THROUGH LEARNING OBJECTIVES

4.1 **What are Learning Objectives?** When data has been collected and analyzed, it is important to establish learning objectives before moving on to training design. Learning objectives clearly define what the goal of the training is. They define what it is that the trainees are expected to learn throughout the training, and what the trainees will be able to achieve post-training that they could not before. The learning objectives usually refer to increased knowledge, improved skills or changed attitudes, and may reflect one or a combination of these.

4.2 **Knowledge objectives** refer to learning new concepts, rules, principles, and strategies, such as concepts for urban planning or land readjustment strategies.

4.3 **Skill objectives** can be technical, mental or social. Technical skills include constructing a road or learning how to use a computerized reporting system. Problem solving and decision making are examples of mental skills, while leadership and communication are examples of social skills.

4.4 **Attitude objectives** refer to the way the trainees perceive and respond emotionally, physically, verbally and intellectually to others.

4.5 During the training design, the learning objectives will guide the process and make sure that all activities are contributing to learning that is relevant to the trainees. The learning objectives are also crucial when delivering and evaluating the training. By comparing the outcomes of the training with the learning objectives it can be determined whether or not the training was successful.

4.6 **Writing Effective Learning Objectives** describe the utmost importance in conjunction with the client. They are a significant stakeholder in the training as they are the ones that must enable and support the trainees upon the conclusion of the training, to adopt the learning into the workplace. Thus, the objective must

have the client's full support; specifically of those within management. To ensure that the trainees, their managers and the training institution all are aware of and agree on the objectives a learning contract and a performance contract may be helpful. The learning contract is a simple document, drawn up by the employee being trained and the trainee's manager. It includes a signed statement by each person that describes certain behaviours they commit themselves to in regard to the forthcoming training. A performance contract is a similar document, but signed by the trainee and the trainer.

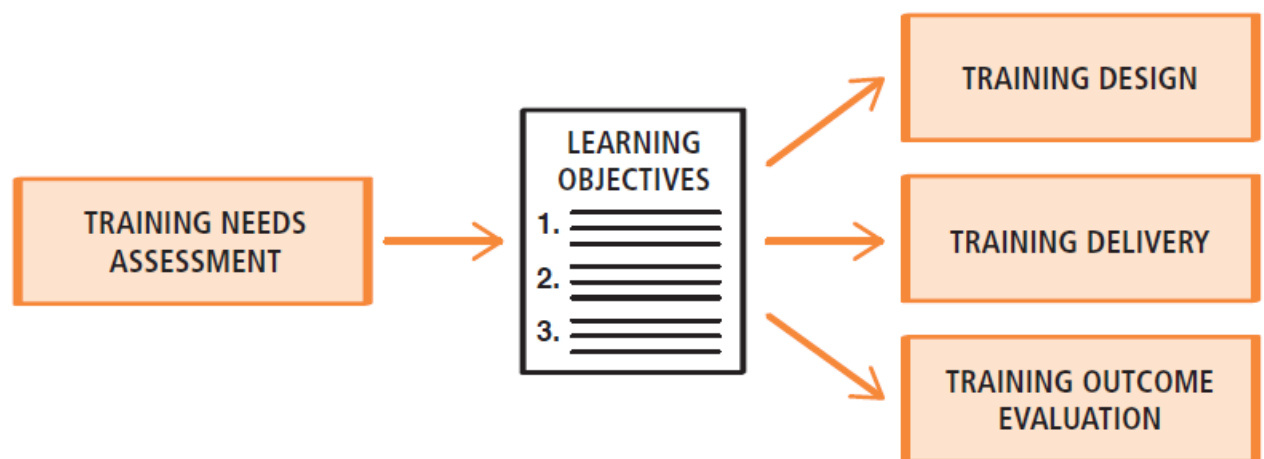


Figure 4.6 : The learning objectives are keys in all stages of the training process following the analysis.

4.7 The best learning objectives are clear and can easily be determined whether or not they have been met. This information sheet recommends that the objectives follow the **SMART** pattern:

- i) **Specific**
- ii) **Measurable**
- iii) **Appropriate** (in terms of culture: social, economic, political, etc.)
- iv) **Realistic** (size, scope, etc.)
- v) **Time framed**

4.8 Having clear objectives will enable the trainer, trainees and their workplace to know whether or not the training was successful in achieving the objectives.

4.9 Objectives in effective training are not about how many people or who attended the training. Rather, they are specifically related to the material the trainees are being taught; meeting the overall purpose which is to develop their capacity to be able to accomplish their tasks in a more effective way. Having a specific objective will not only guide the direction of the training design, but it will also provide valuable criteria for the evaluation.

4.10 **Learning and Behavioural Change** defined a clear and agreed upon understanding of learning objectives between the training institution and client will enable the training institution to develop a training programme that effectively focuses on achieving the objectives within the client's context. The training will be designed specifically for the trainees to clearly understand the concepts and their application, as well as to support them in changing behaviours necessary to increased job performance.

4.11 **Translating the Learning Objectives into Training Design** is specifically designed to meet the learning objectives. It may be useful to understand training in the perspective of a Results Chain. This process ensures that the trainer has a clear understanding of what each training activity will result in. Each effort or activity on behalf to the trainer should lead to the trainees learning a specific skill which will help them reach their ultimate learning objective. Remember to ask the simple questions when planning a training program. What will trainees learn from each element of training and how will it help them achieve the learning objectives? Is spending 15 minutes on a certain diagram necessary? Will it result in helping the trainees meet the learning objectives? Is there a better way of transferring this knowledge? The trainees will have different learning styles so using various pedagogical methods is important to ensure all trainees have the opportunity to fully grasp the concepts and benefit from the training.

4.12 Learning objectives are most likely to be met when the trainers follow-up and monitor the trainees as they implement their learning. Furthermore, trainers should be continuously improving their own knowledge by conducting evaluation and sharing the lessons learned with co-workers and colleagues. Many practical tools exist to ensure that follow-up, monitoring and evaluation are conducted effectively. Using a variety of tools is helpful. It ensures there is a holistic view or diverse perspectives consulted about the learning objectives as they are

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implemented and followed-up on. Using various tools also aids in understanding and maximizing the effects of the training. Consider using tools such as the **Follow-Up Plan, Five “W” Interview** or **Learning Improvement Plan**.

5. TRAINING OUTCOME EVALUATION

5.1 **Proving the Value of Training** shows without an evaluation or understanding of the result of the training it is impossible to determine whether or not the investment in the training programme was successful. Never before has knowing the value of an investment been more important than at this time of current financial crisis, which is increasing the global competition for investments. Therefore organizations, including training institutions and beneficiaries of training, must be increasingly accountable for every dollar. Training evaluations, proving the final outcome of the training investment, are more crucial than ever before.

5.2 Through a training outcome evaluation the training institution can prove the effectiveness of its services; that the institute delivers training programmes that improve the performance of the participants and their organizations. In the same way evaluations are critical to the organization investing in training, the client, to prove they are not wasting resources on activities which do not lead to positive results. The evaluation also provides important feedback that can improve future training cycles of both the training institution and the client. By learning from successes and mistakes of previous training experiences the training effectiveness can continuously improve.

5.3 **Levels of Evaluation** describe that evaluations can be carried out on different levels: evaluating training events and participants’ immediate reactions, evaluating participants’ learning, evaluating job performance outcomes, and evaluating organizational performance and change (Figure 6). These levels are directly related to Donald Kirkpatrick’s “hierarchy of learning”, which describes how the result of each level depends on the previous levels.

5.4 It is common to evaluate the participants’ reactions in the end of an event, but the other levels are unfortunately not as often considered. Compared to

evaluating participant reactions it is harder to evaluate learning, job performance and organizational performance. However, only evaluating the participants' reactions in the end of the event does not provide the training institution nor the client, with sufficient information about the results. The higher levels have to be studied to see if learning has occurred and whether or not it has been transferred to the workplace. Only then it is possible to know if the training has had the desired outcome on the trainees, their job performance, and the organizational performance, and ultimately if the training investment has paid off.

5.5 To evaluate all four levels is particularly important for extensive training programmes and for completely new training programmes that have not been delivered before. For all training programmes the first two levels, participant reaction and learning, should be evaluated.

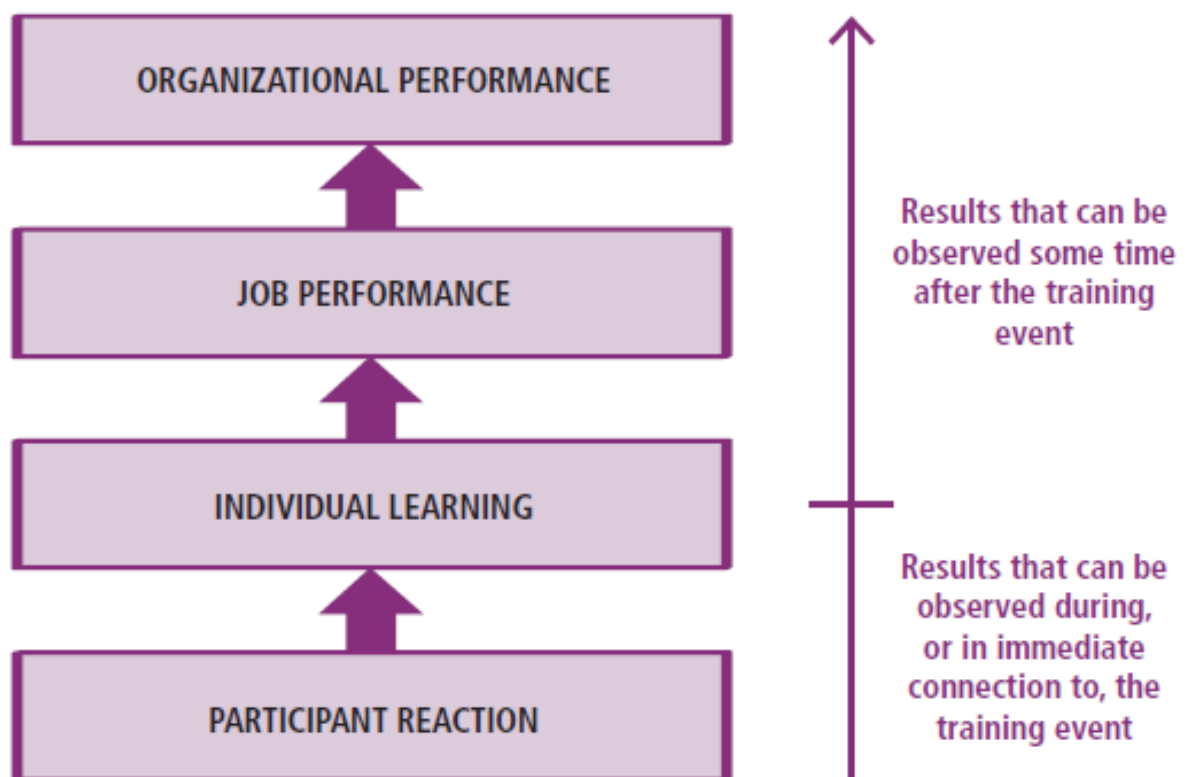


Figure 5.5 : Four levels of evaluation.

5.6 **Meeting the Challenges of Evaluations** explains the overall scenario of a more challenging situation to evaluate participants' learning, their job performance, and organizational outcomes, especially because there may be a lack of interest from many of the stakeholders to engage in evaluations after the

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event. Reasons include evaluations being perceived as too costly or as taking too much time from the people involved. Despite all the benefits to evaluations, sometimes the cost of an effective evaluation does outweigh the cost of the training programme. If the training participants are from different organizations or geographical regions it could also be difficult to keep contact with all of them once the training event is over. Another barrier to conducting evaluations is that they often do not fit within the time frame of typical short project cycles. It may be a relatively long time after the training event before any substantive result on a job performance level can be seen. Furthermore, some people find it impossible to isolate the effect of the training programme on the trainees' job performance from other factors within the organization. Lastly, some training activities are political in nature and when the primary interest is a visible activity training evaluations may be of low priority.

5.7 These challenges are important to be aware of and should be taken into consideration at the planning stage of a training programme in order to be able to respond effectively. This can be done by including evaluation in the training programmes' budget and time plan, deciding on a suitable extent of evaluation, and informing the client and other stakeholders about the benefits of investing in a training outcome evaluation.

6. MANAGING THE EVALUATION PROCESS

6.1 The training outcome evaluation has its starting point in the training needs analysis/analysis and the learning objectives. It is planned in parallel with the design and delivery of the training and carried out both during training events and post-training. Figure 6.1 illustrates the different stages of the evaluation process and how they contribute to proving the results of training and collecting "lessons learned" to improve future training programmes.

6.2 While comprehensive evaluations are useful, it is important not make the process too complicated, time consuming and costly. Training outcome evaluation is a management tool and should be driven by the need to provide enough

information for the client to make good decisions about future training investments, and for the training institution to continuously improve their training programmes. However, only focusing on the training intervention itself, without noting if learning has occurred and been transferred to the workplace, will not provide enough information for future improvements.

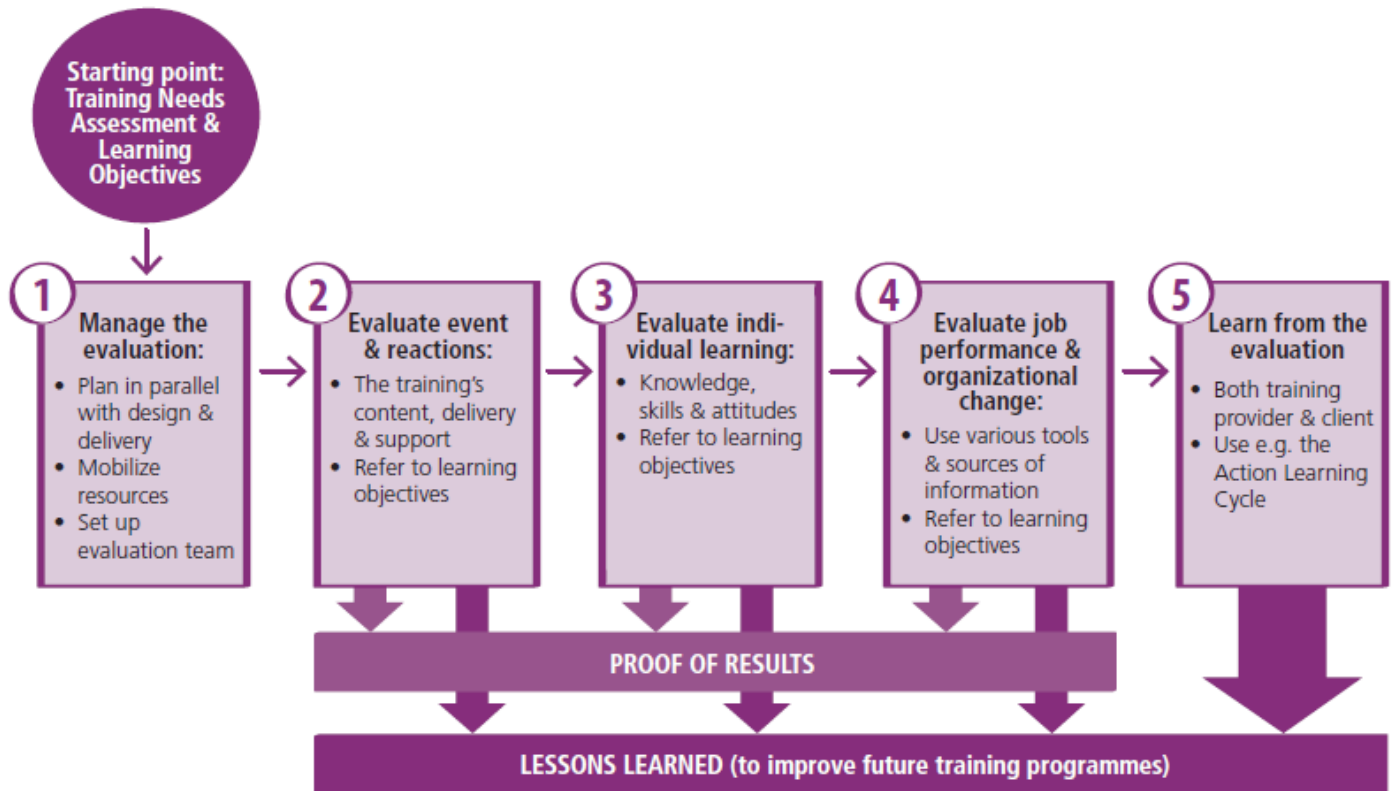


Figure 6.1: The training outcome evaluation process.

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6.3 In mobilizing resources, evaluations are an integral part of the training programme and the resources for training outcome evaluations should be allocated already when setting up the training budget. If evaluation resources are not mobilized by the time the training is complete there are less opportunities to find funding in time to conduct an effective evaluation. When setting up the training budget it may be necessary to negotiate with funders, making the value of investing in evaluations explicit, to convince them to include funds for post-training evaluations. Re-prioritizing activities can also be considered to make funds available for evaluation. Less interventions or fewer participants, but a good follow-up and evaluation, is likely to have greater impact than carrying out many interventions that are never evaluated.

6.4 Resource mobilization might work slightly different for those training institutions which only conduct evaluations. However, it is equally important to be able to convince potential funders of the importance of evaluations. Previously conducted evaluations can be used to prove the value of evaluations, as well as the value and quality of the training institution's training programmes, and consequently making resource mobilization easier.

6.5 The most common sources for funding of training programmes are the training institution itself, the client, the national government, and various types of international agencies. It is wise to not rely solely on one source of funding but to work with multiple sources. There are different benefits of evaluations to the different types of funders, and the specific benefits are useful to stress in the negotiations for funding.

6.6 **Training institutions** should invest in evaluations to prove the effectiveness of their training programmes and to learn from the process in order to improve future training activities. Proof of what learning and performance change the training results in is valuable to promote the institute's training programmes, especially when mobilizing resources.

6.7 **The client** benefits from evaluations by gaining knowledge of whether or not their training investments paid off, and why it did or did not. By evaluating the training the client can make better informed decisions on future training investments.

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6.8 **National governments** often provide financial support for training of local governments. Evaluations are an opportunity to be accountable to the tax payers by proving that their money is invested wisely in activities which have a positive effect on the performance of local authorities and are likely to improve the services provided to citizens. In addition, the national government can improve the overall training effectiveness of the country by making sure that the trainings they support are evaluated and that the lessons learned are documented and shared.

6.9 A training outcome evaluation requires engagement from several stakeholders and ideally they should all be represented in the evaluation team (Figure 6.9). At all times an internal evaluation has to be conducted by members of the training institution. This should include, but not exclusively, the trainer or training facilitator.

6.10 While it is important for the training institution and particular trainer to evaluate their own work, it is also advisable to use external evaluators. This means someone who was not directly involved in the training, in the organization of the training institution or client, or in the organization who funded the training. An external evaluator is less likely to be biased by personal interests, which adds credibility to the outcome evaluation. It also increases the likelihood of accurately identified results, which is crucial for the evaluation to be of value.

6.11 Training institutions usually have access to a large network. Draw upon this when forming the evaluation team. It may be advisable to include peers, technical experts, or civil society in the evaluation team. Consider including an internal member of the training institution, or trainee, if possible. Often a mixed team comprised of individuals from various related fields, will provide useful insights from their mix of different strengths, perspectives, vested interests and motivations.

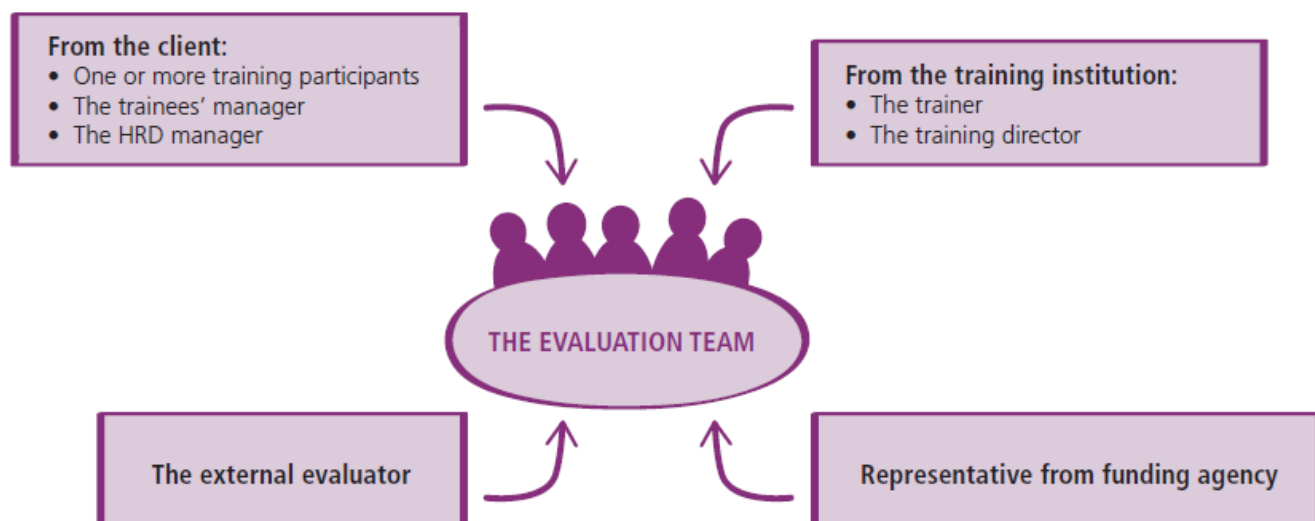


Figure 6.9 : The evaluation team.

6.12 How about consideration of Training outcome evaluation versus costs? Before conducting a training outcome evaluation, potential barriers should be considered and the benefits of the evaluation weighed against the costs. There may be cases where lack of engagement from the stakeholders would impede the evaluation or make the results less useful. In some situations it may be necessary to stress the value of evaluations to the client or other stakeholders, before conducting the evaluation.

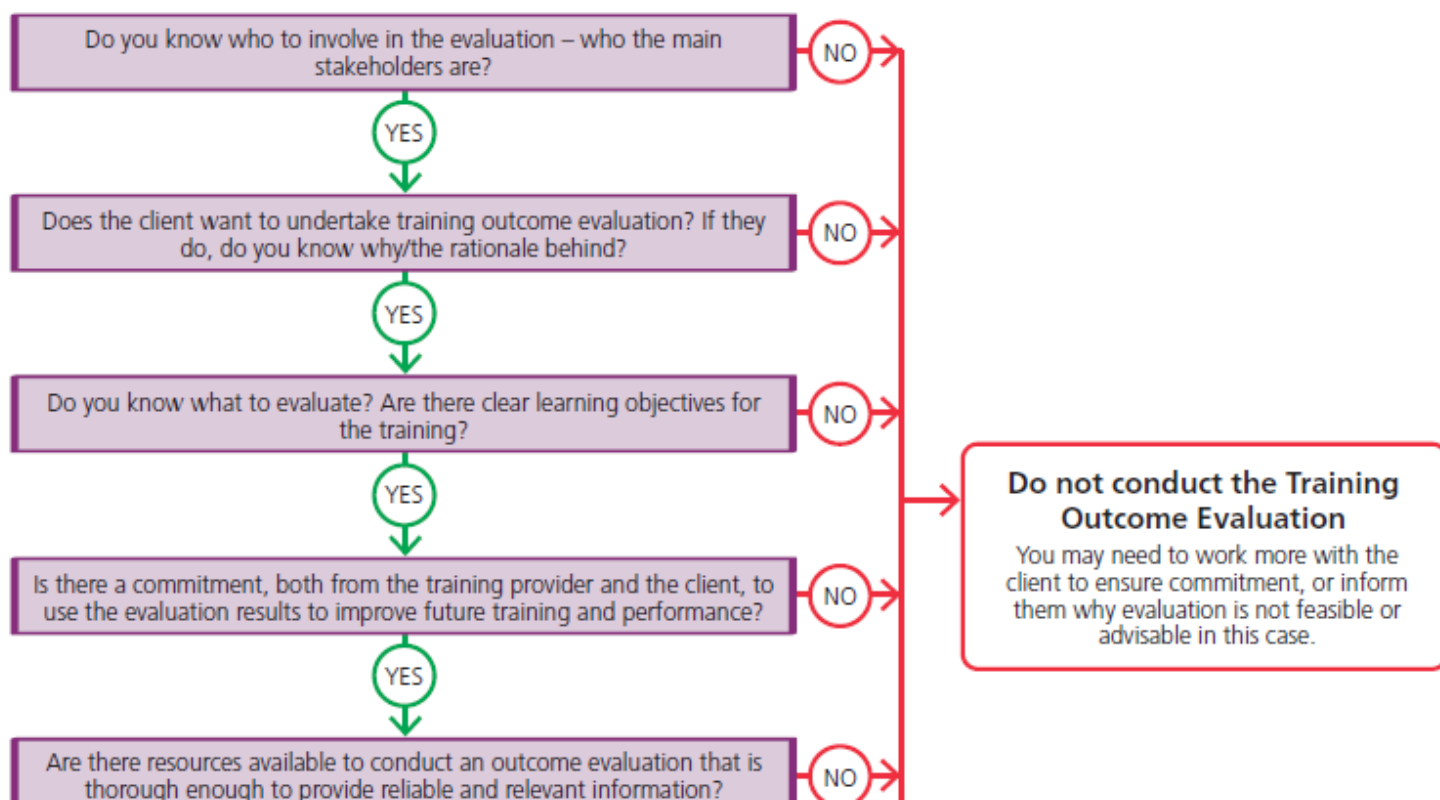
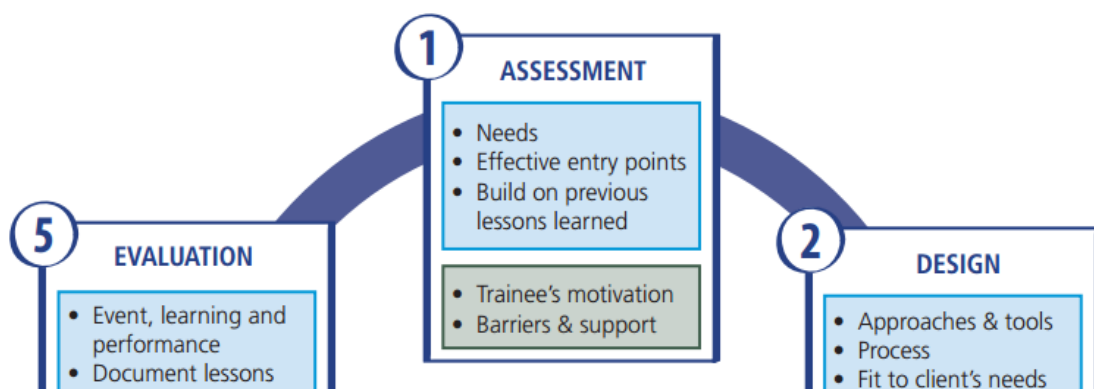


Figure 6.12 : Checklist to support decision on whether or not to conduct a training outcome evaluation.

While this information sheet suggests that evaluations should be built into all training programmes, there are some situations where conducting an evaluation may not make sense as the costs simply outweigh the benefits. The decision to not conduct an evaluation should be consciously made and the reasons well understood by the training institution and client. In Figure 9 is a checklist on what needs to be in place before conducting a training outcome evaluation. This is useful in supporting the decision on whether or not to proceed.

7. THE COMPARISON BETWEEN THE LEARNING CYCLE AND TRAINING CYCLE

7.1 When training is considered to be an effective approach to the identified problem adequate analysis, design, delivery, follow-up and evaluation of the training are all crucial to ensure positive outcomes. These are the five basic steps of the training cycle (Figure 7.1).



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Figure 7.1 : The training cycle.

7.2 During the analysis the context and needs of the trainees and their organization are studied and objectives for the training are set according to what the organization wishes to achieve. The design of the training builds on the findings of the analysis and the defined learning objectives. Training delivery is the conduct of training, usually in the form of one or more events. Follow-up is conducted to monitor and assist trainees post-training as they implement what they have learned. Finally, evaluation is carried out to see if the objectives of the training have been met and how the training process can be improved.

7.3 However, for the training to positively affect the trainee's work another dimension has to be added to the training process. The application of learning to the workplace is usually referred to as transfer of learning, and each step of the training process should be carried out in a way that supports transfer of learning. This includes, for example, identification of potential barriers and enhancers to transfer of learning within the organization during the analysis, addressing these barriers and enhancers in the design, building in follow-up activities, keeping the trainees motivated during the delivery, and involving the trainees' managers in the process.

7.4 The traditional linear or cyclic process of training has to be applied with flexibility. It might be necessary to loop back to the design phase during the delivery to adapt the training to changed circumstances, follow-up activities may run in parallel with the evaluation, and the evaluation should have its starting point already in the analysis.

8. LEARNING FROM THE TRAINING OUTCOME EVALUATION

8.1 To ensure that all potential lessons are learned and applied, training institutions must continuously apply themselves to learning and self-reflection. The need to continuously learn is of critical importance as training institutions must always be developing in order to remain on the cutting edge of theory and practice.

8.2 A popular tool for reflection and learning is the Action Learning Cycle (Figure 8.2), which can be adapted and applied to many different contexts. Using the basic questions in the diagram below, the action learning cycle can be used as a quick review of how the training programme, training needs analysis or training outcome evaluation were delivered, either as a whole or individually. With more time allowed and questions adapted to reflect specific considerations, the action learning cycle can be used for simple as well as complex situations. It can also be used for broad or deep analytical analysis of training programmes' multi-dimensional operations.

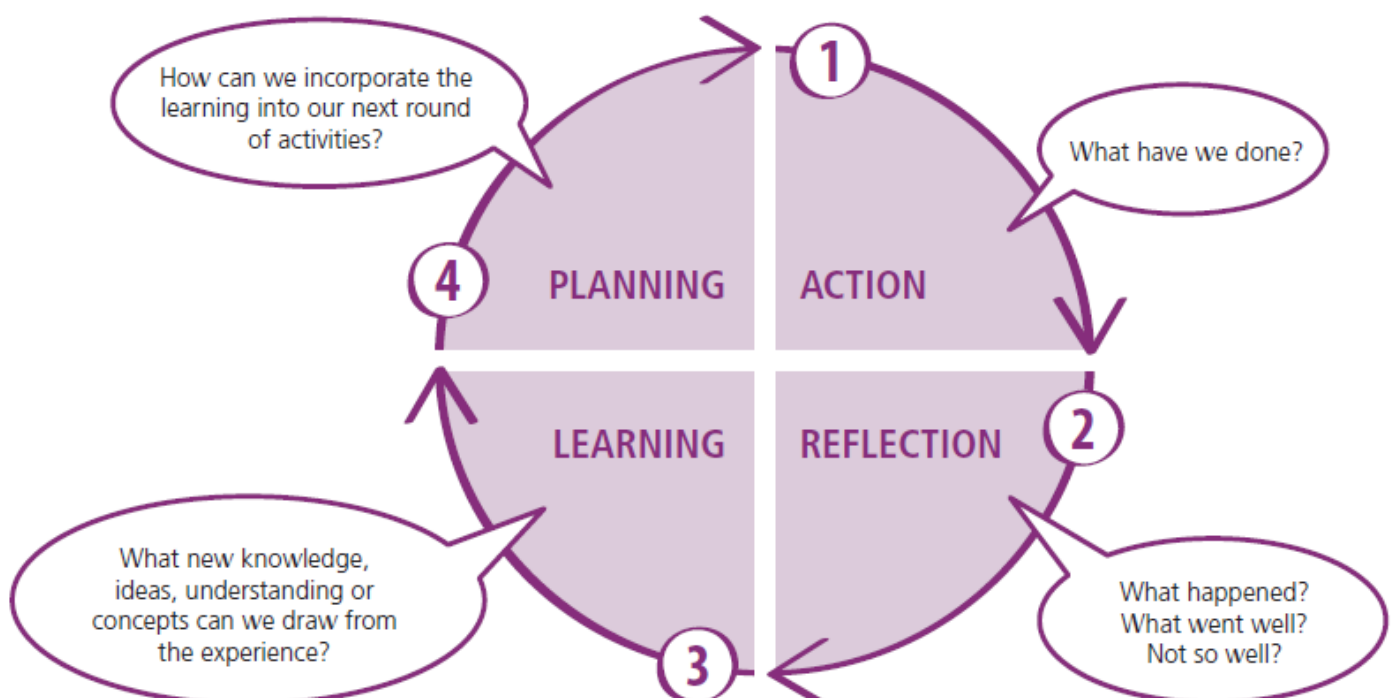


Figure 8.2 : The action learning cycle.

9. TERMINOLOGY

Capacity Development: The process whereby people, organizations and society as a whole unleash, strengthen, create, adapt, and maintain capacity over time.

Capacity Analysis: A capacity analysis identifies capacity on three levels; individual, organizational and enabling environment. It is a more comprehensive approach than training needs analysis as it also looks at the interrelation between each of these levels of capacity.

Learning: Learning is directly related to increased knowledge and understanding; improved technical, mental or social skills; or changes in attitudes or values.

Learning Objective: Learning objectives clearly define what the goal of the training is: what the trainees are expected to learn from the training and be able to achieve after the training.

Outcomes: The likely or achieved short-term and medium-term effects of an intervention's outputs.

Outputs: The products, capital goods and services which result from a development intervention; may also include changes resulting from the intervention which are relevant to the achievement of outcomes.

Training: The passing of knowledge, skills or attitudes from one party or individual to another.

Training Needs Analysis: A training needs analysis looks specifically at the skills, knowledge and attitudes of potential trainees. It uses this information to determine if and how the issue can be improved by training.

Training Outcome Evaluation: A training outcome evaluation is carried out to see if the objectives of the training have been met and how the training process can be improved. Results can be measured on four levels: the event and the participants'

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immediate reactions, the participants' learning, the participants' job performance, and the organizational performance.

SOALAN/ QUESTION:

1. What is Training Needs analysis?
2. Explain in brief four methods used for data collection.
3. Explain the learning objectives could affect the training outcome evaluation.
4. How will the training programme improve the trainee's performance at their workplace?
5. What are the four levels of evaluation?
6. What is the action learning cycle?

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